



THE GREAT *Gift of Loving* FAMILIES

THURSDAY

TODAY'S GIFT

Learning, sharing,
and growing love in
our family every day.

MEMORY VERSE

Be kindly affectionate to one
another with brotherly love,
in honor giving preference to
one another; Rom 12:10 NKJV

MEMORY VERSE ACTIVITIES

Hold hands in a circle and say one word of the verse in turn until you have completed the verse.

Say it a few times until you all know it by heart. Then, give each other a big hug.

INTRODUCTION

The Importance of Love

While not every couple has children, God designed marriage to create safe, loving homes where children can grow and feel loved. Children thrive in families filled with affection, encouragement, comfort, and security. When babies and toddlers receive consistent love and care, they develop a healthy sense of identity and build strong brains prepared for empathy and compassion.

Sadly, children who face neglect, abuse, or are left to cry without comfort may suffer long-term effects. Trauma in early years can limit brain connections needed for emotional health and caring for others.

These children often struggle with relationships, confidence, and both physical and mental well-being later in life.

God's plan was for marriages and families to be daily places of love, safety, and joy—a reflection of His love for us. As parents, caregivers, or family members, we can help build that environment.

What can you do this week to show God's love to your family?

DEVOTIONAL

The Great Gift of Loving Families

“Wow! It would have been amazing to watch God make our world!” Luke exclaimed. “Yes!” said Lara. “I would love to see God putting stars in the sky!”

“I’d like to help Adam name the animals!” laughed Luke. “Some of them are pretty funny!” Daddy smiled. “I’d love to watch God making Adam and Eve and see how He welcomed them into their new world.”

“I wish I could have seen Adam and Eve meeting for the first time!” said Mommy, giving Daddy a playful wink. “Do you remember when we first met?” “How

could I ever forget?” Daddy grinned and kissed Mommy on the cheek. “I’m so glad we fell in love... that you married me... and I’m super glad you two were born into our family!”

“Families are God’s way of sharing His love,” said Mommy. “God showed Adam and Eve what love was like. Then He told them to have a family and pass that love from parent to child.” “But sin came into the world,” Daddy added, “and people started hurting each other instead of loving each other. That’s why Jesus came—to show us how to love God and love others.”

“OK,” said Mommy, smiling. “I have a fun idea! Luke and Lara, how do you know that Daddy and I love each other? What do we do that shows our love?” Luke and Lara looked at each other and began to think. “You hug each other a lot!” said Luke. “You say thank you to each other!” added Lara. “Daddy forgave Mommy when she bumped the car a little bit!” said Luke with a grin. “And Mommy forgave Daddy when he dropped her vase!” giggled Lara. “You help each other without being asked,” said Luke. “And you say sorry when you hurt

each other, or make a mistake, or forget to do something,” added Lara thoughtfully.

“Yes!” Daddy said. “Every day, we try to do kind things for each other. It makes us both happy when we’re kind, helpful, and thankful.” “I feel safe and happy when I see you loving each other,” whispered Lara. “Me too!” agreed Luke.

“So, how about you two?” asked Mommy. “How do you love each other?” Luke and Lara grew quiet. They knew they sometimes annoyed each other. “We share our toys,” said Luke. “Well... sometimes we do.” “Sometimes we help each other tidy

our room,” said Lara. “I guess we could do more of that.”

Mommy smiled. “We feel happy when you’re kind to each other.” “This week I heard Lara thank Luke for carrying her heavy bag,” said Daddy. “And Luke encouraged Lara when she was doing her homework.”

“Well, we’re learning from you and Mommy how to love,” said Luke, “and I guess you learned it from God!” “We sure did!” laughed Daddy. “And from our own families. Even though no family is perfect, the more we love each other, the more we become like Jesus.”



PRAYING
TOGETHER

Wrapped in Love Prayer

- Hold hands in a circle and take turns to pray loving prayers for the person on your left.
- When everyone has prayed, pray in turn for the person on your right.
- Everyone will have been prayed for twice.
- If anyone feels too shy to pray, they can pray silently and squeeze the hand of the next person when they have finished.
- Finish with a group hug.

MAKING MEMORIES



Family Activities



Love Notes

- Cut paper hearts or make small cards.
- Write a short love note for each family member.



Love List

- Make a list of ways to show love at home.
- Ask everyone their favorite way to feel loved.
- Choose one thing each day to show love to every person.



Love Garland

- Cut out hand-sized hearts from construction paper.
- Find Bible verses about love (like Romans 12:9–18 or 1 Corinthians 13).
- Write one verse on each heart and decorate them.
- Connect the hearts to make a garland and hang it at home.



Memorize Together

- Pick an easy-to-understand Bible version.
- Copy Romans 12:9–18 and learn one verse each week as a family.
- Talk about how to live out each verse at home.



Many Kinds of Love!

- Gather craft supplies.
- Let each person choose a love theme (kindness, patience, encouragement, etc.).
- Create a heart showing that kind of love.
- Display your creations as a family reminder.

THURSDAY AT A GLANCE

THE VERSE

Be kindly affectionate to one another with brotherly love, in honor giving preference to one another;
Rom 12:10 NKJV

THE INTRODUCTION

God calls us to love each other with kind words and caring actions.

THE DEVOTIONAL

Through notes, lists, decorations, and Bible verses, we celebrate love in simple, everyday ways.

THE PRAYER

Thank You, Lord, for showing us how to love through kindness.

THE CONVERSATION

What's one way you'll show love today?